

Lee-Ann Vidal-Covas | PhD

✉ vidall@bu.edu • 🌐 leeannvc.com • in leeannvidalcovas • 🌐 leeannvidal

About me

Research Scientist with 10+ years of experience in linguistic research, data curation, and applied data science. Proven ability to manage projects, collaborate cross-functionally, and communicate complex findings to diverse audiences.

Skills

Data Science & Research

Statistical analysis
Experiment design
Data creation, cleaning & sampling
Data processing & visualization

Research & Project Leadership

Problem-solving
Strategic thinking
Event coordination
Interdisciplinary collaboration
Long-term project & team management

QA & Annotation

Data labeling
Guideline creation
Linguistic data analysis
Quality Assurance (QA)
Automated data extraction

Communication

Grant Proposals
Academic Writing
Conference Presentations
Stakeholder Communication

Tech Tools

R	●●●●	Bash	●●●●
VSCode	●●●●	TeX	●●●●
GitHub	●●●●	HTML	●●●●
Python	●●●●	regex	●●●●

Languages

Native	English, Spanish
Elementary	Brazilian Portuguese

Education

2025 Ph.D., Linguistics, Boston University
2021 M.A., Linguistics, Boston University
2013 M.A., Hispanic Studies & Ling., LSU
2011 B.A., Hispanic Studies & Lit., LSU

Research

Published in peer-reviewed venues; presented at international conferences. See [Academic CV](#) or [website](#) for full list.

References

Available [here](#).

Citizenship

Double Citizenship American & Spanish

Experience

Cogito Corporation

2022 – 2023 **Data Annotator | Machine Learning Annotation**

- Produced high-quality annotated speech datasets to support ML model training.
- Labeled conversational audio (*engagement, energy, pace*), boosting model calibration.
- Evaluated pre-trained models & provided actionable feedback, boosting accuracy.
- Suggested workflow improvements, reducing annotation turnaround time.

Boston University

2018 – 2025 **Doctoral Researcher | Project & Lab Manager**

- Trained 10+ student researchers and developed reusable R & Praat workflows that automated dataset updates, reduced manual processing, and improved data quality & workflow consistency across multiple speech datasets.
- Led all aspects of a multi-year research project on covariation & salience in linguistic contact; developed [annotation guidelines](#) to label the data for 12 properties and built [reproducible R pipelines](#) to clean & analyze 20k+ data points with mixed-effects modeling, resulting in 1 monograph, 1 paper, and 8 presentations.
- Developed and implemented an online experimental study on word order preference in Spanish; recruited participants via Prolific, hosted the study in Qualtrics, wrote [design documents & guidelines](#), and analyzed results using linear & logistic mixed-effects models in R, resulting in 1 paper & 2 presentations.
- Co-organized conference (~1,000 participants), successfully transitioning the international event to virtual format during COVID-19. Oversaw talk selection & programming. Supported publication of proceedings.

St. Joseph's Academy & Academy of the Sacred Heart

2014 – 2018 **Secondary Spanish & Technology Educator**

- Developed and taught multiple Spanish courses; designed curricula, lecture notes, assignments, and assessments for >1000 enrolled students.
- Automated assessments by coding self-grading grammar quizzes, improving feedback speed & freeing class time for project-based learning.
- Designed & delivered a middle school digital literacy curriculum, training students in productivity tools, safe online practices, & collaborative workflows.
- Implemented onboarding workshops for 250+ incoming high school students per year, guiding digital setup & proficiency in Microsoft Office & school platforms.
- Planned & led multiple international immersion programs for 40+ students, ensuring safety, cultural exchange, & logistical coordination.
- Organized statewide Spanish conferences with 200+ participants annually, raising interest in Spanish learning across Louisiana schools.
- Full teaching record available on [website](#) | [Academic CV](#).

Louisiana State University

2012 – 2013 **Graduate Researcher | Project Manager | Spanish Instructor**

- Conducted semi-structured interviews with native speakers of Spanish to study pronoun use; resulting in 1 paper & 8 presentations.
- Developed and taught multiple courses in Spanish; designed curricula, lecture notes, assignments, and assessments for >500 enrolled students.

Communications on Hold

2007 – 2017 **Administrative Coordinator | Office & Production Manager**

- Managed office operations, finances, and client workflows, ensuring efficient project delivery while cutting turnaround time and boosting client retention.